

Geography Paper 1 SL Set 2 Marking Report

Options F and G Student Work

Basis for marking. This report marks the Set 2 student work markdown against the Set 2 question paper and marking guide in plans/. The student answered Option F, Questions 11 and 12(a), and Option G, Questions 13 and 14(a). Spelling and grammar are ignored unless they affect geographical meaning.

Overall Mark

Question	Mark	Teacher rationale
Q11	9/10	The short explanations are strong and mostly follow clear cause-effect chains. The only lost mark is for 11(a)(i), where the student identifies the irrigated core instead of the dryland smallholder region as having the highest percentage of food-insecure households.
Q12(a)	6/10	Reaches the 5–6 band. The answer uses the Democratic Republic of Congo and explains shared drivers such as poor infrastructure, food insecurity, sanitation and healthcare access, plus the effect of undernutrition on disease risk. It remains below the 7–8 band because the two-way relationship is incomplete and the place evidence is general.
Q13	9/10	Most short answers meet the markscheme. The student loses one mark for 13(a)(i), where the central core is given instead of the informal hillside zone for the highest share of walking or cycling trips.
Q14(a)	8/10	A secure 7–8 band essay. New York City is used as a named example, and congestion charging/tolls and public transport investment are examined with strengths and limitations. It does not reach 9–10 because the comparison of strategies and evidence of effectiveness are not systematic enough for the top band.
Total	32/40	Strong performance on developed short-answer questions and a good traffic-congestion essay. The main lost marks come from two incorrect graph readings and from an extended response on malnutrition and infectious disease that does not fully examine the reciprocal links.

Option F: Food and Health

Q11: Dry Season, Food Prices and Water Access 9/10

Part	Mark	Rationale
11(a)(i)	0/1	The correct answer is Dryland smallholder , or 46%. The student gives Irrigated core , which has a much lower food-insecure-household value on the graph.
11(a)(ii)	1/1	21% is the correct percentage of households reporting child wasting in the dryland smallholder region.
11(b)	2/2	The response identifies a valid mechanism: a dry season reduces rainfall and forces rural users to rely more heavily on stored water or groundwater. It develops this by linking agricultural water demand to lower remaining access to safe water.
11(c)(i)	3/3	The answer gives a clear chain from a climate shock to reduced crop productivity and yield, then to undernutrition and child wasting. The explanation is directly relevant to vulnerable rural households.
11(c)(ii)	3/3	The answer explains that lower crop yields reduce food supply, while food remains a necessity, increasing demand pressure and raising food prices in urban low-income districts.

Q12(a): Malnutrition and Infectious Disease 6/10

This response reaches the upper part of the 5–6 markband. It is relevant, structured and uses a named place, the Democratic Republic of Congo. The student understands that malnutrition and infectious disease often occur in the same places because of shared contextual factors, especially inadequate food storage and distribution, weak infrastructure, poor sanitation, and uneven access to healthcare between Kinshasa and rural areas.

The answer also explains one important biological link: undernutrition reduces the body's ability to stay healthy, making people more vulnerable to infectious disease. This is creditworthy because it links food access, nutrient intake, immune function and disease risk.

The response is held at **6/10** because the link is not examined fully in both directions. A stronger answer would also explain how infectious disease can worsen malnutrition by reducing appetite, increasing nutrient loss, causing diarrhoea, reducing absorption, and slowing child growth. The DRC example is useful, but it is broad; there is limited disease-specific evidence such as cholera, diarrhoeal disease, measles, malaria, TB or other named infectious diseases. The conclusion is relevant but mostly repeats the earlier argument rather than weighing the relative importance of shared causes and direct biological feedbacks.

To move this response into the **7–8** band, the student should develop a clear two-way cycle: malnutrition weakens immunity and increases infection risk, while infectious disease worsens nutrient loss and food insecurity. To reach **9–10**, this should be supported with more precise place evidence and a balanced judgment about whether shared poverty, WASH conditions and health systems are more important than the direct biological feedbacks.

Option G: Urban Environments

Q13: Urban Transport Patterns 9/10

Part	Mark	Rationale
13(a)(i)	0/1	The correct answer is Informal hillside , or 45%, for the highest share of walking or cycling trips. The student gives Central core .
13(a)(ii)	1/1	Outer suburb is correct for the zone with the highest share of private-car trips.
13(b)	2/2	The response identifies high greenhouse-gas emissions from car dependence and develops this through high household car ownership in outer urban zones. This is a valid environmental-stress chain.
13(c)(i)	3/3	The student uses employment and business centralization as an economic factor. The answer links job location to travel distance and then to transport choice, which is enough development for full credit.
13(c)(ii)	3/3	The response identifies transport technology and infrastructure, such as light rail or subway systems, and explains that faster commute times can shift people towards public transport.

Q14(a): Managing Traffic Congestion in New York City 8/10

This essay securely reaches the 7–8 markband. It is focused on the command term **examine** and uses New York City as a named city throughout. The student explains why congestion matters, linking idling traffic to emissions and lost economic productivity, then examines two relevant strategies: tolls/congestion charging and investment in public transportation.

The tolls paragraph is the stronger part of the essay. It explains the demand management logic: charging vehicles entering congested areas discourages car use, reduces the number of vehicles in the toll zone and can reduce travel times. The student also evaluates the strategy by noting financial burdens on drivers and possible displacement of congestion to alternative routes.

The public transport paragraph is also relevant. It explains that toll revenue can be invested in the MTA and that an extensive subway system can reduce the number of cars on the road. The use of the 4.6 million daily subway users is a useful piece of case-specific support. The weakness about uneven subway access is valid because public transport only reduces congestion effectively where it is accessible and reliable.

The essay does not reach **9–10** because the evaluation is not fully systematic. A top-band answer would compare the two strategies more directly, use more precise evidence for reductions in vehicle numbers or travel speeds, and consider time scale, equity and spatial impacts in more depth. It would also distinguish more carefully between managing congestion itself and reducing air pollution or greenhouse-gas emissions as related outcomes.

Main Targets

- Read graph categories carefully before answering 1-mark data-response questions; two marks were lost from incorrect graph identification.
- In 10-mark essays, examine both sides of a relationship where the question asks for **links**, especially feedback cycles such as malnutrition causing disease vulnerability and disease worsening malnutrition.
- Add more precise case-study evidence in essays: named diseases, statistics, specific locations within

the country or city, and measured outcomes of strategies.

- For **examine** questions, keep the useful strength/weakness structure but make the final judgment more comparative and evidence-based.